# PO Guide Part I · Short Notes ✍️

**Part 3:** Mail products · 10 classes of articles · letters, ILC, postcards, book packets, RNP, parcels · registration · insurance · VPP · Speed Post · Business Parcel · international mail

**Yellow** = must remember IMP = asked often 📝 PYQ · State-Year = came in a past paper

Rates are as given in the notes (for the exam). Actual counter rates may have changed since.

## The address side

- Anything written / printed / attached on the address side that hinders reading the address → **not transmitted**
- Stamps that were once valid but are no longer in use → not transmitted · if found in transit, **returned to the sender**

## Mail products and the 10 classes

**Premium products**

Speed Post · Logistic Post · Business Post · Direct Post · Media Post · e-Post

**Traditional products**

Ordinary letters, postcards, ILCs · Registered · Insured letters · Parcels · VPP · Packets

| First class (1–3) | Second class (4–10) |
|---|---|
| 1 Letter · 2 Inland Letter Card (ILC) · 3 Postcard | 4 Book packet · 5 Book packet with printed books · 6 Book packet with periodicals · 7 Blind literature · 8 Sample / pattern packet · 9 Registered newspaper (RNP) · 10 Parcel |

- First **9** = letter mail · the last **1** = parcel mail
- IMP **All Up scheme**: first-class mail goes by air within India **without any air surcharge**
- RNP is sorted like first-class mail, but gets **no** free air transmission

## Letters, ILC, postcards

### Letter

- Any communication closed in an envelope · max weight **2 kg** · postage first **20 g ₹5** + ₹5 per extra 20 g

→ Size: min **14 × 9 cm** · any one side max 60 cm · length + breadth + depth ≤ **90 cm** · roll: diameter 10–80 cm, length + 2×diameter 17–100 cm

→ Flap at the back on the longer side · paper 0.08–0.18 mm, at least **70 GSM**, bends into a "U" · no metal clips / staples

✗ Unpaid letter → **double the postage** · underpaid → **double the deficiency**

## Inland Letter Card (ILC)

→ Price **₹2.50** · max weight **5 grams** PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021

→ Unfolded max 30 × 21 cm (min 28.2 × 18.2) · folded max 21 × 10 cm (min 15.2 × 9)

→ Unpaid → double · underpaid → double the deficiency · breaking the rules → taxed as a letter

→ Private ILCs allowed (DOP sizes) · **not** for foreign countries, except **Pakistan and Nepal**

## Postcard

→ Size **14 × 9 cm** PYQ · Andhra 2021 · private cards just as thick

→ **Nothing** can be attached to a postcard PYQ · Punjab 2021

→ Meghdoot: advertisement in **4 colours** next to the address

→ Competition card: for TV / radio / newspaper contests (now discontinued)

| Card | Price |
|---|---|
| Single | ₹0.50 |
| Reply | ₹1 |
| Printed | ₹6 |
| Meghdoot | ₹0.25 |
| Competition | ₹10 |

### ★ At a glance: letters, ILC, cards

| 2 kg | ₹5 | 5 g | 14×9 | 25 p |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| letter max | per 20 g | ILC max | postcard cm | Meghdoot |

⚠ **Exam trap**
ILCs can't go abroad, **except to Pakistan and Nepal.**

💡 **Remember**
Unpaid = **×2 postage** · underpaid = **×2 deficiency**

## Book packets, blind literature, samples

→ IMP Book packet max **5 kg** PYQ · Chhattisgarh 2021 · size min 10 × 7 cm, max 60 × 30 × 30 cm (roll 10–80 cm)

→ Postage: first **50 g ₹4** + ₹3 per 50 g · air surcharge ₹2 for the first 50 g, then ₹1

- ✗ **No personal / written communication** PYQ · MP 2020 · no money, stamps, cheques · a card headed "Postcard" can't go as a book packet
- ✓ Allowed: greetings, invitations, circulars, horoscopes, pictures, maps · newspapers, printed music · hand-drawn business / legal documents
- ✗ Court summons / notices → **not** as book packets
- → Rules broken → charged letter or parcel postage (whichever applies) · over size / weight → returned · unpaid → double
- → **Printed books** (no adverts, e.g. textbooks) → **₹1 per 100 g**, 5 kg · mark "Printed Books"
- → **Periodicals** → registered with the RNI, price printed on the cover
- → **Sample / pattern** → bona fide trade samples · max **2 kg** · other rules as book packets
- → IMP **Blind literature** → max **7 kg** PYQ · Bihar 2021 · Delhi 2022 · Chhattisgarh 2021 · postage + registration + AD fees **free** · free only by **surface** · marked "Literature for the Blind" · in Braille, ordinary type only for title / contents

## Registered newspapers (RNP)

- → News, published in large numbers at intervals of **not more than 31 days** · follow the RNI + Press & Registration Act 1867
- → Registered by the area's **SP / SSP** (or an independent gazetted postmaster) · "Registered" + number on the first / last page
- → Number format: **DN/XYZ/2024-2026** (DN = division, XYZ = number, 3-year block) PYQ · Andhra 2021
- → First registration valid till **31 December** of the third calendar year · each renewal for **3 years**
- → **No** registration fee · renewal ₹50 (after 30 Sep, before 31 Dec) · after expiry ₹100
- → List of at least **50 subscribers** · at least **100 copies** at a time · max **5 kg**
- → Postage: single copy first 50 g ₹0.25, 50–100 g ₹0.50, ₹0.20 per extra 100 g · packet up to 100 g ₹0.50 + ₹0.20

## Parcels

- → **Anything** except prohibited articles · may contain **one** personal letter to the addressee
- → Any other written communication → **double** letter postage each · suspected → "for open delivery", opened before the addressee · if unpaid, recovered from the sender

- IMP Weight: parcel max **20 kg** · registered parcel from / to a BO **10 kg** · unregistered parcel **4 kg**
  PYQ · Maharashtra 2020 · Chhattisgarh 2021 · Kerala 2021 · Delhi 2022
  PYQ · Odisha · Punjab 2021 · Kerala 2020
- Postage: first 500 g **₹19** + **₹16** per 500 g · home delivery charge above 5 kg
- IMP Parcel found in a letter box → treated and charged as a **registered parcel**
  PYQ · Andhra 2021
- International parcel lost: 40 SDR per parcel + 4.50 SDR per kg

### ★ At a glance: weights

| 2 kg | 5 kg | 2 kg | 7 kg | 20 kg |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| letter | book packet / RNP | sample packet | blind | parcel |

| 10 kg | 35 kg |
|---|---|
| BO parcel | Speed Post |

**⚠ Exam trap**
Blind literature **7 kg** (the highest in letter mail) · BO parcels **10 kg**, others 20 kg.

**💡 Remember**
"**2-5-7-20-35**" = letter · book · blind · parcel · speed

## Registration

- Registered articles pass with special care, but the PO is **not** liable for loss / damage
- Can be registered: letters, ILCs, book / pattern packets, blind literature, RNP, postcards, parcels · postage + fee **prepaid** · at the window, receipt given
- IMP Registration **compulsory**: **insured articles** PYQ · Bihar 2021 · Delhi 2022 · MP 2022 · parcels needing a customs declaration · articles with stamps / cheques / hundis / notes · VP articles
- Fees: registration **₹17** · AD **₹3** · from 01-11-2023, **18% GST** on (postage + registration)
- Compensation (an act of grace, not legal liability): Head of Circle up to **₹100** · international registered 30 SDR
- Copy of the receipt signed by the addressee within **6 months** (₹2)

## Insurance

- All charges (postage + registration + insurance) **prepaid** · stamps spaced apart so they don't hide damage
- Insured value ≤ real value · gold, coins, notes → insured for the **actual value**
- IMP To / from Army Post Offices: max **₹500**
- **Compulsory** for: coins, bullion, precious stones, gold / silver, notes · VP amount above **₹1500** (except papers / books of no intrinsic value)
- Packing: strong cover, **identical wax seals** on every flap (private mark, not a coin) · no black / coloured borders or transparent windows · gold → wooden / metal case
- At the window · value in words and figures, no corrections · sender's address bottom left · AD **free**
- Compensation paid **1 month** after the loss is reported · never more than the value lost

**No compensation when:** wrong / incomplete address · fraud · addressee signed the receipt · loss not reported within **3 months** · poor packing · no visible damage to cover / seals · notes / gold not insured for actual value · halves of notes · damage from the nature of the article · prohibited contents

## VPP (Value Payable Post)

- The addressee pays when taking delivery; the money goes to the sender by **MO**
- Can go VP: registered parcels, letters, book packets, RNP · **not** "Snowball" (coupon / ticket) schemes
- Declaration: sent on a bona fide order · documents of no intrinsic value allowed (railway receipts, bills, policies)
- Only **MO office to MO office** · amount in the form · on the article: **"VP" + amount at the upper left**, sender's address lower left
- Bulk VP: at least **10** uninsured VP articles · enquire with the local SPOs
- IMP Not taken within **7 days** → returned on the **8th day**
  PYQ · UP 2020 · Chhattisgarh 2021 · written request + fee for 7 more days (fee not refunded)
- On return the sender pays any dues · prepaid fees are never refunded
- Complaints within **6 months**, a fee per article (refunded if right) · suspected fraud → Head of Circle may withhold payment
- Govt is liable only once the amount is received within 6 months · insured value and VP amount can differ (a repaired watch)

### ★ At a glance: registration, insurance, VP

| ₹17 | ₹3 | ₹100 | ₹500 | ₹1500 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| registration fee | AD | registered compensation | APO insurance limit | VP needs insurance |

| 7 days |
|---|
| VP detention |

> ⚠️ **Exam trap**
> Report an insured loss within **3 months**; money is paid **1 month** after reporting.

> 💡 **Remember**
> "**Insured means registered too**" · VP = wait 7 days, back on day 8

## Speed Post

- The Department's **flagship** product · rate by distance + weight · up to 50 g anywhere **₹35**, local **₹15** (taxes extra)
- IMP Max weight **35 kg** 📝 PYQ · Kerala 2020 · Haryana 2022 · Chhattisgarh 2022 · MP 2022 · insurance up to **₹1 lakh**
- Tracking: **13-character** number on indiapost.gov.in or the "Post Info" app
- Compensation: **double the charges or ₹1000** (whichever is less) · treated as lost after **60 days** from booking or 30 days from complaint (whichever is later)
- Contract customers: money back guarantee, BNPL, COD up to **₹50,000**, discounts (+1% with advance deposit, +2% above ₹25 lakh a month)
- Delivery in a BO takes **1 extra day** · size: one side or length + girth not over 150 cm
- Treated as a Speed Post parcel if: over **500 g** · larger than 38 × 27 × 2 cm · or declared "Merchandise"

### Business Parcel

Contract customers · premium surface service · free pick-up, BNPL, COD ₹50,000 · insurance **optional** · uninsured loss: **₹500 or actual value** (whichever is less)

## International mail

- Foreign mail is processed at **Offices of Exchange**: **Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai, Kochi**
- Services: letters, postcards, aerogrammes, small packets, blind literature, printed papers, **M Bag** (newspapers / books for one addressee)

- Registration: letters, small packets, printed papers → **₹150** per article · registered M Bag lost: 150 SDR
- **EMS (International Speed Post)**: max **35 kg** · one side 1.5 m, length + girth 3 m · merchandise lost: value or **130 SDR** · delay over 5 days → 5% of postage
- International parcel: length 1.05 m, length + girth 2 m · min surface 90 × 140 mm · **customs declaration required** · compensation 40 SDR + 4.50 SDR / kg, max 130 SDR
- **SAL** (Surface Air Lifted) = surface inside the country, air between countries
- Paid for delivering inward mail: EMS merchandise min 5 SDR · parcels 7 SDR
- **International Tracked Packet** → e-commerce, to the **Asia-Pacific** region

  📝 PYQ · Bihar 2020 · compensation ₹1000 or actual value

### ★ At a glance: speed and foreign

| 35 kg | ₹1 lakh | 13 | 60 days | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Speed / EMS | Speed insurance | tracking characters | treated as lost | Offices of Exchange |

| ₹150 |
|---|
| foreign registration |

**⚠️ Exam trap**

Speed Post compensation = **double charges or ₹1000, whichever is less** (not the higher one).

**💡 Remember**

Offices of Exchange = "**Mu-De-Ko-Che-Ko**" (Mumbai, Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai, Kochi)

### ✍️ Test yourself

1. Max weight of a blind literature packet?
2. A registered parcel from a BO can weigh up to?
3. A parcel found in a letter box is treated as?
4. A VP article is returned after how many days?
5. Max weight of Speed Post?
6. To which countries can an ILC go?

Answers: 1 7 kg · 2 10 kg · 3 A registered parcel · 4 On the 8th day (after 7) · 5 35 kg · 6 Pakistan, Nepal

Source: PO Guide Part 1 · MTS / Postman notes, pages 55–81, condensed